

# Lead CRM for the Home-Kitchen Delivery Business

## Confirmed Requirements & Build Plan

Prepared for: Novasie · Prepared: July 2026

### Context

This CRM is only for managing sales conversations with leads — it sits alongside your existing customer app, home-chef app, and admin dashboard, which continue to handle orders, users, and delivery. Today, Meta (Facebook/Instagram) ads redirect people into WhatsApp, but that conversation happens on a regular WhatsApp Business app account, one chat at a time, with no team visibility or automation. This document lists exactly what you approved as must-have, what to deliberately leave out for now, and the order in which we'll build it.

### 1. Confirmed Requirements

| Requirement                                                | Status                | What this means / what's needed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A lead is created automatically, however it arrives        | Partly there          | Facebook/Instagram form-ads already create leads automatically. A lead starting as a direct WhatsApp message (someone clicking an ad and messaging in) does not yet create a lead automatically — this is new work, and it also needs the official WhatsApp connection (see Requirement 5) to be in place first. |
| WhatsApp number is the unique ID for every lead            | To be built           | Today two leads could exist with the same number. We'll make the number required and unique, and clean up any existing duplicates before switching the rule on. Search by name or number will keep working as it does today.                                                                                     |
| Flexible classification (what kind of deal this is)        | Already works         | The CRM already supports free-form tags on any lead — this covers “regular order” vs. “bulk / event order” and anything else you want to classify by, with no new development needed. We'll just set up the specific tags you want to use.                                                                       |
| Hide fields you don't need right now (Organization, etc.)  | Already works         | The CRM has a built-in, no-code screen for showing/hiding fields per form. We'll hide Organization and other company-style fields now; turning them back on later (e.g. once you start taking bulk orders for events) is a checkbox, not a rebuild.                                                              |
| Keep notes, tasks, convert-to-deal, email                  | Already works         | All already built and working — nothing to change here.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Chat with leads on WhatsApp from inside the CRM, as a team | Blocked on Meta setup | The CRM software side of this already exists (shared inbox, sending photos/files, replying to messages). It cannot go live until your WhatsApp number is moved onto Meta's official WhatsApp Business Platform — see the Prerequisite section below. This is a Meta account step, not a coding step.             |
| Send automated / bulk messages to leads                    | To be built           | Not built yet. Also depends on the official WhatsApp connection being in place first.                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Feed captured leads back into Meta for retargeting ads     | To be built           | Not built yet, and the most involved piece. Depends on the lead-identity work (Requirement 1–2) and the WhatsApp connection both being done first, since we can't retarget someone we can't reliably identify.                                                                                                   |

## 2. What We're Deliberately Leaving Out (for now)

Two different kinds of “not now” — worth telling apart so expectations are set correctly:

### Just hidden — flip a switch later, no rebuild

- Organization / company name fields, and other B2B-style fields — come back instantly if you start taking bulk/event orders (e.g. a Puja order or a 10-person party booking).

### Not built at all — would need real development later if you ever want them

- Multi-step drip/follow-up sequences (e.g. automatic day 1 / day 3 / day 7 messages).
- Auto-reply or chatbot for common questions.
- A no-code “if this happens, do that” automation builder.
- Automatically forwarding conversion events to Meta, or auto-adjusting a campaign's budget/status.

*None of this is being built in this plan. If any of it becomes important later, it gets scoped and estimated on its own — it won't block or complicate the plan below.*

## 3. The One Prerequisite Everything Else Depends On

Right now your WhatsApp number is a regular WhatsApp Business app account. Meta does not allow that kind of account to connect to any external software — by design, for anti-spam reasons. To get team chat, automation, or ad retargeting working at all, that number (or a new number) needs to be moved onto Meta's official WhatsApp Business Platform (also called the Cloud API). This is done through your Meta Business account, not through code, and Meta's own review of the number can take anywhere from a couple of days to a couple of weeks — worth starting this in parallel with the development work below, since it's the one thing on the critical path we don't control.

## 4. Build Plan

*Ordered so nothing depends on a later step. Time estimates are development effort for one person; the Meta review time in Phase 0 runs in parallel and isn't counted in the totals.*

### Phase 0 — Move to the official WhatsApp Business Platform

*~1–2 days of setup work, plus Meta's own review time running in the background.*

- Register (or migrate) your WhatsApp number on Meta's WhatsApp Business Platform.
- Connect that number to the CRM's WhatsApp tool and confirm test messages send and receive correctly.

### Phase 1 — Clean up lead identity

*~3–4 days.*

- Make WhatsApp number required and unique on every lead; merge any existing duplicates first.
- Build the simple “Add Lead” action: type a WhatsApp number, system checks if it already exists, then opens or creates the lead.
- Hide Organization and other B2B fields from the lead/deal forms.
- Set up the specific classification tags you want (e.g. Regular Order, Bulk/Event Order).

### Phase 2 — Turn on real WhatsApp chat + auto-capture

*~5–7 days (depends on Phase 0 being complete).*

- Verify the CRM's existing shared WhatsApp inbox, media sending, and templates all work correctly on your live number.
- Build automatic lead creation the moment a new number messages in via WhatsApp — whether they came from a Facebook ad, an Instagram ad, or just messaged you directly.

### **Phase 3 — Automated / bulk messaging**

*~5 days.*

- Build the ability to message a chosen list of leads at once.
- Add the ability to schedule a message for later, or send on a recurring basis.

### **Phase 4 — Feed leads back to Meta for retargeting**

*~6–8 days.*

- Connect to Meta's ad-campaign tools.
- Automatically push qualifying leads into a Meta retargeting audience so they see your ads again.
- Keep a simple log of what was sent to Meta and when.

### **Total**

Roughly 4–5 weeks of development time end to end, not counting Meta's own review of your WhatsApp number in Phase 0 (which can run in the background while Phase 1 is underway).